

Anger Time-Out Plan

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: A time-out plan interrupts escalating anger before it leads to words or actions you regret. Plan it in advance with anyone it affects, so a time-out is understood as a coping skill — not walking away from the relationship.

My early warning signs

Physical (e.g., clenched jaw, hot face, fast heart), thoughts, and behaviors that signal rising anger:

The anger number where I will call a time-out (0 = calm, 10 = explosive):



My time-out steps

- Signal: the word or gesture I'll use (e.g., 'I need a time-out').
- Leave the situation calmly — no last word, no slamming.
- How long I'll take: ____ minutes. Where I'll go: _____.
- What I'll do to cool down (walk, paced breathing, cold water, NOT rumination or substances).

My specific cool-down activities:

Coming back

How I'll return and re-engage respectfully once I'm under my anger number:
